

Colormap design considerations

Perceptually distinguishable colors

Value distance matches perceptual distance

Colors and concepts properly align

Aesthetically pleasing, intriguing

Respect color vision deficiencies

Should survive printing to black & white

Don't overwhelm people's capability

...

Colormaps

colorhunt.co

color.adobe.com

...

I often handpick
based on existing
palettes. Probably
not the best practice

Industry Standard

ColorBrewer

MicroSoft

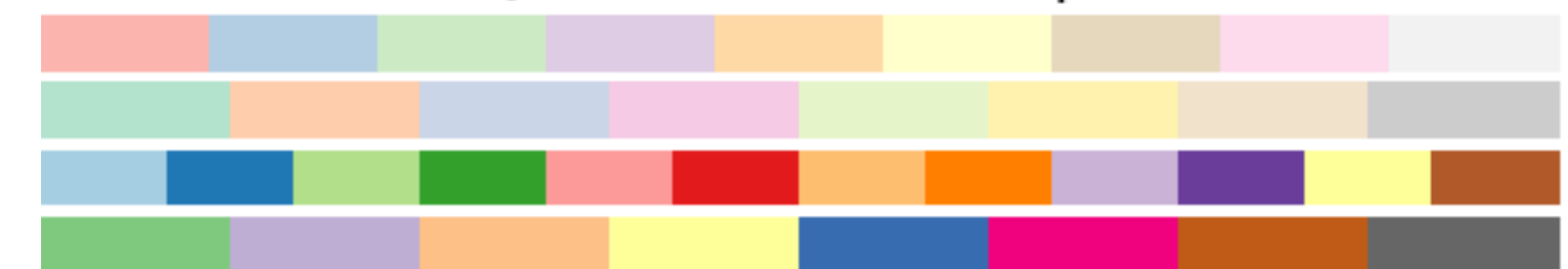
Tableau



Matplotlib (Python), R, D3, ...

I show a subset here:

Qualitative colormaps



Diverging colormaps



Sequential colormaps



Perceptually Uniform Sequential colormaps

